

Chapter 172-1

As spring was about to arrive, even the wind carried warmth.

Xu Qingzhu's words, carried by the wind, fell into Liang Shi's ears, making them feel ticklish.

Liang Shi raised her head and unexpectedly met Xu Qingzhu's gaze, who had been staring at her intently.

Their eyes met.

Those light brown pupils reflected not only tonight's hazy moon but also the person she loved.

Liang Shi's gaze wandered, glancing around randomly.

After a moment, she changed the subject, lowering her head to pick up the food. "Aren't I already being supported by Teacher Xu?"

Xu Qingzhu knew she didn't want to talk about this matter and shrugged indifferently. "You know that's not what I mean."

"Then what is it?" Liang Shi's tone was teasing. "Are you planning to confront Dongheng head-on?"

Xu Qingzhu pouted. "It won't come to that."

Liang Shi: "?"

Liang Shi glanced at her sideways. "Won't come to that? Teacher Xu, those words really hurt my feelings."

Xu Qingzhu laughed softly. "What else? If I clash with Dongheng, that means clashing with Big Brother. What are you thinking? Should I yield to him or should I yield to him? Sister-in-law is about to give birth. It would be too underhanded of me to do that now. What would you do if your little niece hated you?"

Liang Shi: "....."

"Isn't she your niece too?" Liang Shi poked her shoulder with the other end of her chopsticks.

Xu Qingzhu picked up some food with her chopsticks and brought it to her mouth, answering with a smile. "She is."

And just like that, the topic was easily set aside.

Xu Qingzhu knew Liang Shi had her own plans. Liang Shi knew Xu Qingzhu respected her thoughts.

That was enough.

The production crew was still filming as usual. Zhao Ying still had some scenes left to shoot.

It would probably go until past 3 AM.

Zhao Ying was over there going through the script with the director, rehearsing scenes. She yawned twice, and her assistant handed her coffee.

When she saw Xu Qingzhu, she raised her hand to wave hello but didn't have time to come over.

Xu Qingzhu handed the milk tea she'd bought to her assistant, but Zhao Ying said she was watching her weight. She was even drinking sugar-free coffee and didn't dare touch things like milk tea at all.

Things were busy over there. Liang Shi was too tired to move, so Xu Qingzhu sat outside with her.

The two of them sat together chatting casually.

From Yu Wan's due date to the recent trending topics, Xu Qingzhu teased, "Teacher Liang, you don't even need to investigate to know who's targeting you."

"What can I do about it?" Liang Shi said. "Does this count as being punished for possessing a treasure?"¹

"I don't think so," Xu Qingzhu said. "It's just that your opponent is too weak."

Liang Shi: "?"

"I don't count as being punished for possessing a treasure?" Liang Shi asked her.

Xu Qingzhu stared at her carefully, then shook her head after a moment. "What treasure are you possessing? I'd believe it more if you said you yourself are the treasure."

Liang Shi: "....."

"I don't understand her," Liang Shi said. "She pretty much has everything she wants now, right? Why does she still have to do this? If things really go wrong... she can't always have Qiu Zimin clean up after her, can she?"

"It's normal that you don't understand," Xu Qingzhu shrugged. "Why would you try to understand the thoughts of a bad person?"

Liang Shi: "....."

"Just discussing it normally," Liang Shi said. "There are so many people on the trending topics cursing at me... all saying I'm a resource mooch."

Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow. "Why not just prove them right? Otherwise, they'd be cursing for nothing."

Liang Shi: ".....Go away."

Liang Shi raised her hand and lightly flicked her forehead. "Am I that useless in your heart?"

"How could that be?" Xu Qingzhu covered her forehead, then clung to her arm and rested her head on her shoulder. Her cool voice was very low, yet especially captivating: "Please, you're Liang Shi. How could you be useless?"

"Then for such a small matter, you want to step in and solve it for me," Liang Shi said. "Do you think I don't have the ability?"

"No." Xu Qingzhu's eyes were bright, and her voice softened too. "Back when you helped me deal with Bai Weiwei and Chen Liuying, that was enough to show your abilities. But you're filming right now and don't have time to spare. What's wrong with me helping you solve it? Can't I?"

Liang Shi: "....."

"Teacher Liang, this isn't like you," Xu Qingzhu teased. "Are you feeling inferior?"

Liang Shi: "?"

"How could I be?" Liang Shi lightly pinched her face. "My wife being capable is something to be proud of. I don't have that kind of pointless pride. It's just that I've seen too many situations like this. Using capital to silence people doesn't work. The person involved stepping in doesn't work either. Even if being a resource mooch is confirmed, it still doesn't work. The best way to fight back is with your work. When your achievements match your resources, it won't matter what anyone says."

Xu Qingzhu's eyes immediately lit up. While Liang Shi was still thinking, she leaned over and kissed her. "Mwah~"

Complete with sound effects.

Liang Shi immediately covered her face and instinctively looked around.

Xu Qingzhu watched her with a smile. Liang Shi whispered in a panic, "What are you doing?"

"What's wrong?" Xu Qingzhu said. "Is it illegal to kiss you?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Her ears immediately turned red.

Xu Qingzhu rested both hands on her legs. "Then call the police."

Liang Shi grabbed her hands, her smile both indulgent and helpless, and said softly, "There are so many people here."

"It's legal," Xu Qingzhu said. "I just kissed your face..."

Liang Shi widened her eyes. "And you still want to..."

Before she could finish, Xu Qingzhu leaned forward and kissed her lips.

Liang Shi instinctively licked her lips, wanting to laugh but holding it back, her entire face flushed red.

Xu Qingzhu rubbed her forehead helplessly. "How are you so easily embarrassed?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi covered her face. "There are so many people here~"

Xu Qingzhu pursed her lips and leaned forward to kiss her again, but only kissed the back of her hand. Liang Shi also lowered her hand and warned Xu Qingzhu in a small voice, "Watch yourself."

Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow. "Teacher Liang, are you keeping someone on the side in the production crew? Why are you so scared?"

"No." Liang Shi immediately explained. "There are so many people here... You... I... We... Never mind."

Liang Shi didn't know how to explain. It was just that the atmosphere in the crew was very delicate.

Last time when Xu Qingzhu came to see her and just kissed her on the cheek, after Xu Qingzhu left, she was teased for a long time.

Every time everyone went "Ohhh," Liang Shi's face would turn red.

Being intimate in public was something Liang Shi still couldn't quite get used to.

She stood up and pulled Xu Qingzhu to leave, but Xu Qingzhu refused.

Liang Shi turned back and leaned close to her. "Let's go, back to the hotel."

"Why?" Xu Qingzhu asked, tilting her head up.

Liang Shi's throat moved slightly. She cleared her throat softly, leaned over, and said in a low voice, "I want to kiss you properly."

Footnotes:

¹ **"Being punished for possessing a treasure" (懷璧其罪):** A Chinese idiom meaning "the crime of carrying a jade," referring to how possessing something valuable can bring trouble or make one a target. It comes from the story of someone who was killed because others coveted their precious jade. Here, Liang Shi is suggesting she's being targeted because of her resources/connections.